

money or became truly important in the second half of their lives—after letting go of what they did in the first half. Ronald Reagan didn't leave acting to turn to political life. He left acting to retire and relax. Only after settling down for a time did he become interested in being governor of California. Even J. Paul Getty, as we've seen, retired to goof off after he made his first million. His very early retirement set the stage for his later success.

The third basic rule of retirement, from chapter 1, is:

Do what you want

After a few years of retired life you may decide to return to work. If you do, you may decide to try out a new idea. If you try the idea, you may make it or not. If you make it, you're a zillionaire. If you don't, you go back to being retired.

But if you stay working where you are right now, you may never even get the chance to think about it.